

— LEGENDS · NO. 06

THE MIND THAT REWROTE FOOTBALL.

Johan Cruyff · Netherlands · 1947 to 2016.

A 6-part breakdown

SWIPE ►►►

0101 / 06

AJAX MADE HIM, HE MADE AJAX.

Over 200 goals for Ajax and three European Cups in a row, from 1971 to 1973. The boy from Amsterdam became the best player in the world. *The start of something bigger.*



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| TOTAL FOOTBALL.

He was the conductor of the Dutch idea where every player could play every role. Positions turned fluid and space became the point. Football has not looked the same since.
The system was the star.

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| THREE TIMES THE BEST.

He won the Ballon d'Or in 1971, 1973 and 1974. At Barcelona he ended a fourteen-year title drought in his first season. *Wherever he went, things changed.*

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| 1974, AND THE TURN.

His only World Cup. Player of the tournament, and one drag-back against Sweden that still carries his name. The Netherlands lost the final and won the argument. *Remembered for how they played.*

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| HE BUILT THE NEXT ERA TOO.

As a coach he made Barcelona's Dream Team and planted the thinking that became La Masia and tiki-taka. Guardiola, Xavi and Iniesta all grew from his soil. *The greatest assist of his life.*

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| A LEGACY THAT OUTLIVED HIM.

Johan Cruyff died in 2016, aged 68. The game he imagined is the game we watch today.

Football's great architect.

— THE TAKEAWAY

WHO COMES **NEXT?**

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